



Exelon Generation®

Oyster Creek
Route 9 South
P.O. Box 388
Forked River, NJ 08731

10 CFR 50.73

RA-17-053

August 31, 2017

U.S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission
Attn: Document Control Desk or O-8B1
One White Flint North
11555 Rockville Pike
Rockville, MD 20852

Oyster Creek Nuclear Generating Station
Renewed Facility Operating License No. DPR-16
NRC Docket No. 50-219

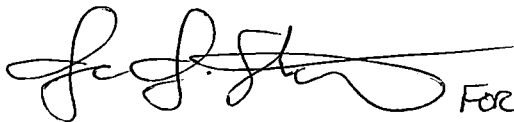
Subject: Licensee Event Report (LER) 2017-003-00, "Automatic Scram while Subcritical due to Low Reactor Level."

Enclosed is LER 2017-003-00 reporting the automatic reactor scram while subcritical due to low reactor water level, which occurred on July 3, 2017.

This event did not affect the health and safety of the public or plant personnel. This event did not result in a safety system functional failure. There are no regulatory commitments made in this LER submittal.

Should you have any questions concerning this report, please contact Gary Flesher, Regulatory Assurance Manager, at (609) 971-4232.

Respectfully,



For M. Gillin

Michael F. Gillin
Plant Manager
Oyster Creek Nuclear Generating Station

Enclosure: NRC Form 366, LER 2017-003-00

cc: Administrator, NRC Region I
NRC Senior Resident Inspector - Oyster Creek Nuclear Generating Station
NRC Project Manager - Oyster Creek Nuclear Generating Station

IE22
NRR

**LICENSEE EVENT REPORT (LER)**

(See Page 2 for required number of digits/characters for each block)

(See NUREG-1022, R.3 for instruction and guidance for completing this form
<http://www.nrc.gov/reading-rm/doc-collections/nuregs/staff/sr1022/r3/>)

Estimated burden per response to comply with this mandatory collection request: 80 hours. Reported lessons learned are incorporated into the licensing process and fed back to industry. Send comments regarding burden estimate to the FOIA, Privacy and Information Collections Branch (T-5 F53), U.S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission, Washington, DC 20555-0001, or by e-mail to Infocollects.Resource@nrc.gov, and to the Desk Officer, Office of Information and Regulatory Affairs, NEOB-10202, (3150-0104), Office of Management and Budget, Washington, DC 20503. If a means used to impose an information collection does not display a currently valid OMB control number, the NRC may not conduct or sponsor, and a person is not required to respond to, the information collection.

1. FACILITY NAME

Oyster Creek Nuclear Generating Station

2. DOCKET NUMBER

05000219

3. PAGE

1 OF 3

4. TITLE

Automatic Scram while Subcritical due to Low Reactor Level

5. EVENT DATE			6. LER NUMBER			7. REPORT DATE			8. OTHER FACILITIES INVOLVED	
MONTH	DAY	YEAR	YEAR	SEQUENTIAL NUMBER	REV NO.	MONTH	DAY	YEAR	FACILITY NAME	DOCKET NUMBER
07	03	2017	2017	- 003	- 00	08	31	2017	N/A	05000
9. OPERATING MODE			11. THIS REPORT IS SUBMITTED PURSUANT TO THE REQUIREMENTS OF 10 CFR §: (Check all that apply)							
N			☐ 20.2201(b)		☐ 20.2203(a)(3)(i)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(ii)(A)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(viii)(A)	
			☐ 20.2201(d)		☐ 20.2203(a)(3)(ii)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(ii)(B)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(viii)(B)	
			☐ 20.2203(a)(1)		☐ 20.2203(a)(4)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(iii)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(ix)(A)	
			☐ 20.2203(a)(2)(i)		☐ 50.36(c)(1)(i)(A)		☒ 50.73(a)(2)(iv)(A)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(x)	
10. POWER LEVEL 00			☐ 20.2203(a)(2)(ii)		☐ 50.36(c)(1)(ii)(A)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(v)(A)		☐ 73.71(a)(4)	
			☐ 20.2203(a)(2)(iii)		☐ 50.36(c)(2)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(v)(B)		☐ 73.71(a)(5)	
			☐ 20.2203(a)(2)(iv)		☐ 50.46(a)(3)(ii)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(v)(C)		☐ 73.77(a)(1)	
			☐ 20.2203(a)(2)(v)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(i)(A)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(v)(D)		☐ 73.77(a)(2)(i)	
			☐ 20.2203(a)(2)(vi)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(i)(B)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(vii)		☐ 73.77(a)(2)(ii)	
					☐ 50.73(a)(2)(i)(C)		☐ OTHER		Specify in Abstract below or in NRC Form 366A	

12. LICENSEE CONTACT FOR THIS LER

LICENSEE CONTACT

Gary Flesher, Regulatory Assurance Manager

TELEPHONE NUMBER (Include Area Code)

(609) 971-4232

13. COMPLETE ONE LINE FOR EACH COMPONENT FAILURE DESCRIBED IN THIS REPORT

CAUSE	SYSTEM	COMPONENT	MANUFACTURER	REPORTABLE TO EPIX	CAUSE	SYSTEM	COMPONENT	MANUFACTURER	REPORTABLE TO EPIX
A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A

14. SUPPLEMENTAL REPORT EXPECTED☐ YES (If yes, complete 15. EXPECTED SUBMISSION DATE) ☒ NO**15. EXPECTED SUBMISSION DATE**

MONTH	DAY	YEAR
N/A	N/A	N/A

ABSTRACT (Limit to 1400 spaces, i.e., approximately 15 single-spaced typewritten lines)

On July 3, 2017 at approximately 10:30 hours with the reactor subcritical after a manual scram, an automatic reactor scram occurred due to low Reactor Pressure Vessel (RPV) water level. Prior to this event, Main Control Room (MCR) Operators established reactor water letdown, reset the manual scram and were placing RPV water level control in automatic using a Low Flow Feedwater Regulator Valve (LFRV). Reactor pressure control was automatically being maintained with turbine bypass valves. A low reactor water level occurred when a bypass valve opened as expected to lower reactor pressure.

Operations personnel had reset the scram signal without fully evaluating other plant conditions. Upon resetting the scram with reactor water level not yet stabilized, an automatic scram was received on low reactor water level. The automatic scram initiation signal occurred with the plant in a shutdown mode.

**LICENSEE EVENT REPORT (LER)
CONTINUATION SHEET**

(See NUREG-1022, R.3 for instruction and guidance for completing this form
<http://www.nrc.gov/reading-rm/doc-collections/nuregs/staff/sr1022/r3/>)

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1. FACILITY NAME	2. DOCKET NUMBER	3. LER NUMBER		
Oyster Creek Nuclear Generating Station	05000219	YEAR	SEQUENTIAL NUMBER	REV NO.
		2017	- 003	- 00

NARRATIVE**Plant Conditions Prior To Event**

Event Date: July 3, 2017
Unit 1 Mode: Hot Shutdown

Event Time: 10:30 hours ET
Power Level: 0%

Description of Event

On July 3, 2017 at approximately 10:30 hours a subcritical automatic reactor scram was received while stabilizing plant parameters after a manual scram. The automatic scram was due to low RPV water level. Prior to this, MCR operators established reactor water letdown, reset the manual scram and were placing RPV water level control in automatic using a LFRV. Reactor pressure control was automatically being maintained with turbine bypass valves. A low reactor water level occurred when a bypass valve opened as expected to lower reactor pressure. Operators reset the scram signal without fully evaluating other plant conditions. By resetting the scram signal with water level not yet stabilized, an automatic scram was received on low reactor water level.

Operator fundamentals and human performance tools were not properly utilized prior to resetting the scram. Operations personnel did not ensure plant parameters of pressure and level were stable prior to resetting the scram. An expected pressure transient resulted in an automatic scram due to RPV level dropping below the scram setpoint.

Cause of Event

MCR Operators did not confer with the Unit Supervisor their intended actions nor did they provide an update to other control room personnel prior to resetting the scram. Operations personnel did not perform a thorough review of all system conditions prior to peer checking the scram reset. Additionally, the procedure did not provide details of conditions to verify prior to resetting the scram.

Analysis of the Event

The personnel involved did not display distinct thought to understand the impact that the action would have with reactor water level control in its current state. The operators should have taken the time to understand that resetting the scram at that time was not the correct action. The operators were not fully engaged and did not think about the consequences of resetting the scram prior to reactor water level stabilization. Their behavior represents a gap as described in SOER 10-2, Engaged, Thinking Organizations.

Assessment of Safety Consequences

Following the automatic scram actuation all systems responded as expected; therefore, this event is of low safety significance.



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NARRATIVE

Corrective Actions

- 1) The station revised the Abnormal Operating Procedures for MCR operators to verify plant conditions are stable prior to resetting the scram signal.
- 2) Reinforcement of the requirements and proper use of operator human performance fundamental tools through training and evaluations.
- 3) Reinforcement of teamwork in MCR operations during training scenarios.

Previous Occurrences

LER 2013-005-00 was submitted when Oyster Creek Nuclear Generating Station, while shut down, experienced an automatic reactor scram when operators placed the Mode Switch from Refuel to Shutdown. The actuation was a result of jumpers not installed as required by procedure to prevent a full scram for this Mode Switch change.

Component Data

Component	IEEE 805 System ID	IEEE 803A Component
N/A	N/A	N/A